

Garden Centre Operations

Science

May, 2026



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Ollscoil
Teicneolaíochta
an Oirdheiscirt

South East
Technological
University

Garden Centre Operations (A06688)

Short Title: Garden Centre Operations
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Horticulture
Author DFLANAGAN
Credits 5

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module is designed to equip students with knowledge of garden centre management and planning. Students will also learn about promotion, sales methods, display and maintenance of garden centre plants. The student will learn how to critique a garden centre.

Programmes

HORT -0018	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_D)	3 / 6 / E
HORT -0018	BSc in Horticulture (WD_SHORT_DX)	3 / 6 / E

Indicative Content

- Market analysis and trends
- Garden centre planning: Types of garden centre, location, site development, creating identity, range of products, security
- Shop layout and customer flow
- Stock control: Planning purchases, making orders, receiving plants, environmental requirements, standing areas for plants
- Promotion and product display, sale promotion, packaging, maintenance of displays, quality assurance schemes
- Display and maintenance of plants, sales techniques

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Explore market and industry trends for garden centres.
2. Propose recommendations on garden centre planning, including the creation of a safe working environment.
3. Plan customer flow and product displays.
4. Examine stock control systems, management and pricing.
5. Explore opportunities for garden centres to balance cash flow.
6. Inspect a garden centre layout.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures
- Site visits
- Workshop
- Project
- Practicals

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,3, 4, 5,
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	25%	6
<i>Assignment</i>	25%	2

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Lacking in technical ability/skill and understanding to carry out practical/professional tasks. Failure to meet the objectives of projects. Unable to carry out or submit independent study and research.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the subject matter. Shows some technical ability/skill in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks. Attempts made to meet objectives and carry out independent study and research. Final result lacks balance and arguments undeveloped.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrates satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Logically and competently carries out practical/professional tasks. Satisfactory handling and awareness in carrying out independent study and research. Reporting and projects adequately structured and referenced.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrates sound knowledge of the subject matter. Shows ability to analyse and logically argue in an effective and mature style. Demonstrates initiative and the ability to criticise methods used and appreciation of experimental design when carrying out practical/professional tasks. Projects and reporting coherent and soundly structured illustrating wide and in depth reading on subject coupled with the proper use of references.
- 70%-100%:** Demonstrates authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject. Provide well focused analysis and convincing argument on the subject. Demonstrates imaginative approach, excellent technical ability, awareness, and aptitude in carrying out and reporting on practical/professional tasks. Shows initiative, individual thought, and enthusiasm in self-study and independent learning.

Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Practical	12	
Field Trips	12	
Independent Learning	87	

Supplementary Material

- "John Stanley Blog." <http://www.johnstanley.com.au/johns-blog/>

- Snook, C. and K. Carter. _Garden centre manager_. England: Grower books, 1999.
- Stanley, J. _The complete guide to garden__center__management_. USA: Ball, 2002.